



Computer Science Honor Society

Section 1: Name

Bylaws of Olathe South Computer Science Honor Society

ARTICLE I: NAME AND PURPOSE

The name of this organization shall be the Olathe South Computer Science Honor Society (hereafter referred to as Society). It will also be known as Olathe South Computer Science Honor Society.

Section 2: Purpose

The purpose of the Society shall be to cultivate thriving environments for success in computer science in the school community by encouraging students' enthusiasm, honoring academic excellence, and promoting service.

ARTICLE II: CHARTER

Section 1: CSTA & Constitution

The Society shall operate under the direction of the Computer Science Teachers Association, LLC (CSTA) and in full compliance with the Computer Science Honor Society (CSHS) Constitution.¹

Section 2: Ongoing Requirements

The Society shall retain an active charter from CSTA by meeting the following ongoing requirements:

1. School offers one or more sections of computer science;
2. Advisor maintains active CSTA+ membership;
3. Advisor agrees to all CSHS guidelines;

¹ The current version of the CSHS Constitution is available online at [CSTeachers.org/CSHS](https://www.csteachers.org/CSHS).

4. Advisor completes annual report by deadline;
5. Society maintains active membership;
6. Society pays annual membership fees to CSTA;
7. Society provides meaningful service to the local community;
8. Society demonstrates commitment to improving equity in computer science; and
9. Society holds regular activities.

Section 3: Forfeiture of Charter

Failure to conform to the CSHS Constitution or the ongoing requirements may result in the forfeiture of the Society's charter. If a charter is forfeited, the school must resubmit a petition and pay for a new charter, should it want to have a society in the future.

ARTICLE III: ADVISOR AND FACULTY COUNCIL

Section 1: Appointment

The Society advisor shall be a member of the faculty, appointed annually by the principal, and may serve consecutive terms. The school principal shall have the final authority on activities and decisions of the Society.

Section 2: Responsibilities

The Society advisor shall be responsible for the direct, day-to-day supervision of the Society and act as a liaison between faculty, administration, students, and the community at large.

Section 3: Records

The Society advisor shall maintain files on membership, activities, financial transactions, honors, and service hours.

Section 4: Annual Report

The Society advisor shall complete the annual report, which includes information on member demographics, Society activities, and the total number of service hours, and submit it to the CSTA by the established deadline.

Section 5: Membership Dues

The Society advisor shall submit an updated number of members and associated student membership dues to CSTA within 30 days of every induction event.

Section 6: Membership Compliance

The Society advisor shall regularly review each member for compliance with the Society's standards and obligations.

Section 7: Support of Officers

The Society advisor shall help the student officers understand and carry out their duties.

Section 8: Faculty Council

The faculty council shall consist of the Society advisor and two or more additional faculty members, appointed annually by the Society advisor. Members of the faculty council may serve consecutive terms. The purpose of the faculty council shall be to evaluate membership applications and to determine discipline and dismissal of Society members.

ARTICLE IV: MEMBERSHIP

Section 1: Eligibility

To be eligible for induction into the Society, the candidate must meet the following requirements:

1. Be a student in the 9th, 10th, 11th, or 12th grade;
2. Have attended Olathe South for at least one semester;
3. Have completed at least one semester of rigorous computer science coursework
4. Have earned at least 80 percent, B, or 3.0 (on a 4.0 scale) in computer science courses; and
5. Demonstrate service and leadership.

Section 2: Selection of Members

Selection for membership shall be by application and based on computer science achievement, leadership, and service. Once selected, members shall have the responsibility to continue to demonstrate these qualities.

1. The selection of new Society members shall be held annually.
2. Applications shall be available to all Olathe South students for at least two weeks. Membership applications and criteria shall be advertised through newsletters, school announcements, posters, social media, and flyers.
3. The Society advisor shall ensure each candidate meets eligibility requirements.
4. The Society advisor will ask Olathe South faculty and administration to give input on candidates' applications. This input will be included and considered with their applications.

5. The Faculty Council shall review applications and select members based on their academic performance, leadership, and service in computer science courses and related activities.
6. No student shall be denied membership on account of discrimination or limitation based upon race, gender, gender identity, pregnancy, national origin, political affiliation, religion, ethnicity, physical or mental disability, citizenship status, and/or sexual orientation.

Section 3: Induction and Dues

1. Students become active members at a special induction ceremony held in October.
2. Students inducted into CSHS shall receive a pin to signify their membership in the Society. Members in good standing shall maintain the privilege of wearing the CSHS pin.
3. Other Society activities and/or events may require additional fees. The Society officers and/or advisor will announce these activities and/or events in advance and will not require member participation.
4. Students who are unable to pay the required fees may request a waiver by appealing directly to the Society advisor. Students' ability to pay fees will not impact their eligibility.
5. Students who do not pay dues or make arrangements to have their dues waived shall be dismissed from membership and shall be ineligible to reapply.

Section 4: Graduation

1. Society members in good standing shall receive an honor cord in the CSHS colors to wear at graduation. The Society's budget will cover the cost of honor cords.
2. Membership status will change from active to *graduate* at the time of graduation from Olathe South. Graduate members may not vote on Society activities.

Section 5: Service Obligations

1. Each Society member shall have the responsibility for choosing and participating in individual service that reflects his or her particular talents and interests. This is in addition to the Society service projects to which all members contribute.

2. Each Society member shall complete a minimum of ten hours of community service each academic year of membership. At least half of these hours (five hours) shall include service related to computer science. Members shall turn in a log of their time to the Society secretary.
3. Society members shall not submit service hours that have been submitted for other clubs, organizations, or courses (i.e., no “double dipping”).
4. Society members may complete additional hours to earn achievement recognition as follows:
 - a. 25 hours: Bronze service award
 - b. 50 hours: Silver service award
 - c. 100 hours: Gold service award

This award is to reflect service for a single academic year.

5. Maintain at least a 80 percent, B, or 3.0 (on a 4.0 scale) in computer science courses

Section 6: Transfer of Membership

1. CSHS members who transfer to Olathe South from another school and bring a letter from the previous principal or society advisor to the new Society advisor shall be accepted automatically as a member in Olathe South Computer Science Honor Society.
2. Transfer members must meet the Society’s standards within one semester in order to retain active membership.
3. Transfer members shall be responsible for paying annual dues to Olathe South Computer Science Honor Society regardless of their transfer date to Olathe South. Students unable to afford the annual dues may request to the Society advisor to have their dues waived.

Section 7: Discipline, Dismissal, and Resignation

1. A Society member who fails to meet membership standards shall be promptly warned in writing by the Faculty Council and given a reasonable amount of time to correct the deficiency. In the case of flagrant violation of school rules or the law, a member does not have to be warned before being disciplined or dismissed.
2. A Society member who fails to complete the required number of service hours at the end of the school year shall be given a single warning by the Faculty Council.

The member shall have the opportunity to complete their hours in the upcoming summer. However, if the member does not complete the remaining hours or fails to meet the service requirement in a subsequent year, they will be dismissed from the Society and will be ineligible to reapply.

3. The Faculty Council in compliance with the rules and regulations of Olathe South and the CSHS Constitution, shall determine the procedure for dismissal. A written description of the dismissal procedure shall be made available to interested parties. A Society member who has been dismissed may appeal the decision to the principal.
 - a. The student and parents/guardians will be notified in writing of the Society Advisor's review indicating the reason for the consideration for dismissal.
 - b. The student has the right to respond to the charge(s) at a hearing before the decision of the Society Advisor.
 - c. The decision made by the Society Advisor will be reviewed by the principal.
 - d. The student and parents/guardians will be notified in writing of the decision.
 - e. The student has the right to appeal the decision within 2 in session school weeks in writing. All appeals will be reviewed by the principal. The student and parents/guardians will be notified in writing of the final decision.
4. A Society member who resigns or is dismissed from membership shall return the CSHS pin to the advisor and will never again be eligible for membership or its benefits.

ARTICLE V: MEETINGS AND ACTIVITIES

Section 1: Meetings

1. Olathe South Computer Science Honor Society shall hold regular meetings monthly. All Society members shall attend.
2. Olathe South Computer Science Honor Society will also meet as needed to work on service projects or any other events requiring additional meeting time.
3. Society shall conduct meetings according to *Robert's Rules of Order, Newly Revised* in all points not expressly provided for in the Society bylaws.

Section 2: Service Projects

1. The Society shall choose one or more computer science-related service projects for each academic year. Example projects include outreach, recruitment, student support, new learning opportunities, and community engagement / support. All Society members shall regularly participate in these projects.
2. Service projects shall have the following characteristics:
 - a. Fulfill a need within the school or community;
 - b. Have the support of the administration and the faculty;
 - c. Be appropriate and educationally defensible; and
 - d. Be well planned, organized, and executed.

ARTICLE VI: LEADERSHIP

Section 1: Executive Committee

Olathe South Computer Science Honor Society shall be led by a group of elected student officers in collaboration with the Society advisor.

1. The Executive Committee shall consist of the Society officers and advisor.
2. The Executive Committee shall have general supervision of the affairs of the society between its business meetings, make recommendations to the society, and determine and perform such other duties as are specified in the society bylaws. All actions and recommendations of the Executive Committee shall be subject to the review of the society membership.
3. The Executive Committee shall ensure that the Society activities and procedures follow the policy and regulations of Olathe South and those specified in the CSHS Constitution.
4. The Executive Committee shall examine and compare the demographics of Society membership to the overall school enrollment at least once per year. The Executive Committee shall make and execute plans to equitably recruit new Society members each year and attempt to have society membership reflect the diversity of the school community.

Section 2: Officer Roles

Olathe South Computer Science Honor Society shall have a President, Vice President, Secretary, Treasurer, and Webmaster elected annually by the membership.

Section 3: President's Duties

1. The President shall conduct all meetings of Olathe South Computer Science Honor Society.
2. The President shall engage the Society membership in selecting and implementing at least one service project per school year.
3. The President shall establish a calendar of meeting dates for both the membership and the Executive Committee.

Section 4: Vice President's Duties

1. The Vice President shall conduct meetings and responsibilities in the President's absence.
2. The Vice President shall be responsible for researching and selecting activities for the Society. Example activities include enrichment field trips, extension learning opportunities, social events, and competitions.
3. The Vice President shall lead the annual induction ceremony.

Section 5: Secretary's Duties

1. The Secretary shall keep the minutes of Society meetings and events.
2. The Secretary shall communicate to Society members and the community.
 - a. Social Media
 - b. Society Website
 - c. School News paper
 - d. School Announcements
3. The Secretary shall collect and compile service logs from each Society member.
4. The Secretary shall update a scrapbook at least once per year with photos and information about events and activities of the Society.

Section 6: Treasurer's Duties

1. The Treasurer shall maintain updated financial records of Olathe South Computer Science Honor Society.
2. The Treasurer shall collect membership dues and other fees.

3. The Treasurer shall ensure that pins, cords, and other materials are purchased and available for distribution.

Section 7: Webmaster's Duties

1. The Webmaster shall maintain the Society website.
2. The Webmaster shall update the site with upcoming events, highlights of past events, and any other pertinent public information for Society members.
3. The Webmaster shall collaborate with the Secretary to maintain an active social media presence.

Section 8: Elections

1. Any Society member in good standing shall be eligible as a candidate for a single officer position.
2. Elections shall be held prior to induction of new members. All Society members in good standing are eligible to cast one vote for each office by secret ballot.
3. Officers shall be elected by a plurality vote. In the event of a tie, the Society advisor will decide the winner of the office in question.
4. New officers shall be installed at a special ceremony.

Recruitment Strategies that emphasize equality

Recruitment efforts for the school as a whole would include the following:

- Posters
- Advertising to clubs that involve Computer Science related activities
- Highlight that any skill level is good
- Show the potential of Computer Science
- Meetings/Presentations for everyone in the school to see what it is all about
- School Announcements
- School Assembly
- Emails/newsletters to the school

When looking at equality, we as a school have a very diverse student body and also have a very diverse participation in the Olathe Computer Science 21st Century Academy (A program run by the Olathe School District that sets students on the path for computer science and gets them real world practice while in high school) is also very diverse. The only problem that arises is female involvement in the Computer Science field. The following Strategies will be used to try and increase female involvement and participation.

- Show female role models in Computer Science
 - Ada Lovelace
 - Katherine Johnson
 - Etc
- Advertise to the Girls Who Code program at Olathe Schools to try and get more female involvement in the Computer Science Academy and Olathe South Computer Science Honor Society
- Work with other school clubs that work in diversity and female involvement to help increase female involvement and possibly other groups involvement as well
 - S.A.S.H. (Students Achieving Social Harmony)
 - Women's Empowerment Club
 - G.S.A (Genders and Sexuality Alliance)

Planned Service Projects

Because Olathe South already has the Computer Science Academy there are already some activities put in place that involve Computer Science such as the Computer Science Carnival. But with a Computer Science Honor Society we would open new activities and service projects that could be done outside of school including the following initially:

- Helping retirement homes with their computers
- Help and run Computer Science events in the community to encourage

community involvement in Computer Science

- Computer Science safety events in the community such as Computer Safety, and Defending your children from bad actors
- Run school wide, open house activities in coding to encourage a diverse involvement in the Computer Science Honor Society
- Do outreach activities and influence programs at local middle schools to encourage them to apply to the Computer Science Academy and, if invited to the Academy, to also seek membership in the Computer Science Honor Society (if they want to be in both).

These activities are designed to get the community involved, even outside of highschool. With how big computers are getting and how young children are being introduced to them it is important to practice computer safety; teaching parents how to instill this in their children and themselves is essential to promoting Computer Safety and community engagement in Computer Science.

Planned Goals

A Computer Science Honors Society should focus on diversity, equality, learning, and community engagement within its student body, and the community as a whole. The following goals are what we feel would be the most helpful initially:

- Increase involvement in Computer Science among high school students by organizing regular coding workshops, competitions, and projects, aiming to increase participation rates by at least 10% within the next academic year.
- Launch a community outreach program focused on Computer Safety education, including workshops, seminars, and resources distributed to local schools and organizations, aiming to reach 500 community members within the following six months after the academic year starts.
- Facilitate networking opportunities for high school students by organizing college resume and scholarship workshops with local businesses and universities, aiming to assist at least 50 students in securing college scholarships within the next academic year.